

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

NOTE: This document contains information affecting the national defense of the United States within the meaning of the espionage laws, Title 18, U.S.C., Sec. 793 and 794. The transmission or the revelation of its contents in any manner to an unauthorized person is prohibited by law.

BEST COPY AVAILABLE

DC - II/22 001050
This report contains unprocessed information. It is not to be evolved or modified solely on the basis of this report.

1. COUNTRY: LAOS/THAILAND	8. REPORT NUMBER: 1 856 0138 68
2. SUBJECT: (U) Unidentified Flying Objects	9. DATE OF REPORT: 26 December 1968
3. ISC NUMBER:	10. NO. OF PAGES: 3
4. DATE OF INFORMATION: Nov-Dec. 68	11. REFERENCES: DIRM 1A3e, 1Q8, 2C2 SICR U-UPF 21321
5. PLACE AND DATE OF ACQ: Vientiane, LAOS 19 December 1968	12. ORIGINATOR: OUSAIRA, Vientiane, LAOS
6. EVALUATION: SOURCE (A) INFORMATION (2)	13. PREPARED BY:
7. SOURCE	14. APPROVING AUTHORITY: <i>Robert L. F. Tyrell</i> ROBERT L. F. TYRELL Colonel, USAF Air Attache
15. SUMMARY: (Leave Blank)	

REC'D CO-3 13 JAN 1969

978

TH
405-2000
103156
331215
37305
379150

1. Quote: Subject: Unidentified Flying Objects (U). Part I. A. On 280156Z November 1968, Nakhon Phanom (NKP), HTAFB GCA reported two low/slow moving objects approximately 13NM south of NKP. Contact was lost when objects were 9NM west of base. NKP Command Post was informed they "definitely were not ghosts." Sightings were confirmed by Invert radar. At approximately 0215L Knife 27, night Recce chopper, was asked to investigate slow movers 4NM north-east of base. As Knife 27 was not in immediate area 5-10 minute delay ensued. Knife 27 reported no sightings. Knife 27 also investigated similar phenomena 10-13NM south of NKP and another return two and one-half NM northwest of base. No visual sightings were reported. Final return at 12NM south of NKP was also investigated with Invert direction Knife 27 to position directly overhead of unidentified return. Searchlight was employed but revealed nothing. No object.

16. DISTRIBUTION BY ORIGINATOR CINCPACAF DEPCJUSMAGTEAT	17. DOWNGRADING DATA	18. ATTACHMENT DATA

DD FORM 1396

REPLACES DA FORM 1049, 1 AUG 60,
OPNAV FORM 3523 (Rev 10-61),
AF FORM 112, JUL 61, WHICH MAY BE
USED UNTIL 1 JAN 62

forces, officials, or units by air. It is not likely, therefore, that they would risk valuable aircraft and crews to support Thai insurgent, when resupply, infiltration, and movement by other means is cheaper, safer, and less obvious. It is interesting to note that such unknown returns have been reported since 1965 and yet no unidentified aircraft has ever crashed or been physically observed so it could be identified. Friendly suppression forces have never shot down or hit these unknown intruders, whereas U.S. helicopters and aircraft in VIETNAM and LAOS have suffered many hits and losses, and as indicated in Part I, friendly aircraft in area could not observe, even with aid of lights, any other aircraft. In past, when Royal Thai Government offered 200,000 Baht reward for shooting down of unknown aircraft and helicopters, only aircraft ever hit were BPP or RTA choppers and USAF aircraft on legitimate missions. As result, Thai Government has since withdrawn reward offer since no hostile aircraft or "unknowns" were ever downed. It is also interesting to note that in 1967 unidentified aircraft activity, purportedly in support of communist insurgents, seemed to preoccupy Thai officials until U.S. resources provided Hawk anti-aircraft missiles. Then in speech of acceptance and thanks, General PHRAPHAT, Deputy Prime Minister, said helicopter threat from outside THAILAND had ended or come under control. Part V. This headquarters is highly interested in such sightings and reports, and will continue to monitor such activity for signs of hostile intent. However, there is no evidence at present time to indicate rash of recent "Bogies" reported near NKP RTAFD involves hostile or unfriendly activity. Unquote.

2. The following is quoted from a COMUSMACV message dated 17 December 1968. The message was to CINCPAC with information to 7/13AF and referenced the message quoted above. Quote. "This headquarters considers the message and excellent assessment of unidentified helicopter reports in THAILAND. This evaluation parallels our own assessments." Unquote.

3. The most recent reported sightings occurred in South LAOS. On the night of 14, 16, and 18 December 1968, an unidentified high wing single engine aircraft was observed over Ban Thatong (1526N-10622E), LAOS. On two occasions it was reported circling at low altitude (400 feet). On the third occasion, it was observed at 6000 feet heading west. Estimated speed 100 knots. It has not been determined if the aircraft was an unreported friendly or enemy.

COMMENTS: AIRA concurs with the comments and assessments made and with the conclusion which are drawn. It seems highly unlikely the enemy would take the risks involved to infiltrate personnel or supplies when, as is pointed out, other methods are cheaper, safer and less obvious. Some of the "unknowns" have been reported far enough into THAILAND that large helicopters would have to be used or refuelings made by small helicopters. In order to reach some of these locations, long flights would have to be made over friendly territory, both in LAOS and THAILAND. Again this seems rather unlikely and has not been confirmed by any sightings. There are no known enemy held staging areas or bases in LAOS from which such flights could operate within reasonable range, safety and security and yet remain such a well kept secret for such a long period of time. If any of these flights are, in fact, occurring it appears much more reasonable that they might be unreported friendly activities.